

Palo Alto Networks Network Security Professional

Datasheet

JUNE 2026

The Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Professional certification is designed to validate a candidate's understanding of all products and services included in the Palo Alto Networks network security solution, their use cases, and how they are applicable to an organization. The Network Security Professional exam also validates a candidate's ability to use, maintain, and configure network security products at an entry level, and to perform basic network security product installation and deployment.

The purpose of this document is to help you prepare for the exam and attain the certification. Please note that this document is intended to help identify the topics covered and to provide resources and references for understanding those topics. It is not intended to be used as the sole document to prepare for the Network Security Professional exam.

Audience and Qualifications

Target Audience

This exam is designed for individuals with the following job roles:

- Networking and Security professionals responsible for installing / deploying, operating, or administering the Palo Alto Networks suite of:
 - Next-generation firewall (NGFW) products
 - Cloud-Delivered Security Services (CDSS) subscriptions
 - Next-Generation Trust Security (NGTS) platform components
 - Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) products, including Prisma Access, Enterprise Browser, and Prisma SD-WAN
 - Management products, including Strata Cloud Manager (SCM)
- Individuals responsible for establishing and maintaining the connectivity and security of:
 - Data centers (i.e., on-premises, public cloud, private cloud)
 - Branches and campuses
 - Remote users (i.e., client-based, proxy-based, Enterprise Browser, RBI)
 - Internet-connected devices (i.e., internet of things (IoT), internet of medical things (IoMT), operational technology)
 - Data handling (i.e., SaaS applications, data loss prevention (DLP), cloud access)

Skills Required

- Basic knowledge of securing networks of all sizes
- Configuration of Palo Alto Networks Strata and Prisma SASE products for security outcomes
- Basic knowledge of options for managing Palo Alto Networks solutions (e.g., Panorama, SCM)
- Basic knowledge of configuring relevant Palo Alto Networks products (e.g., hardware, VM-Series firewalls, CN-Series firewalls, Cloud NGFWs, Prisma Access, Prisma SD-WAN, CDSS)
- Basic knowledge NGTS products and solutions
- Basic knowledge of best practices for Strata and SASE products

Exam Details:

- Duration: 90 minutes
- Format: Multiple-choice questions
- Language: English
- Cost: \$200 USD*
- Delivered by: Pearson Professional Assessments

** Price may vary by country*

Blueprint

The blueprint table lists the domains covered and includes domain weighting. The percentage weights represent the portion of the exam score that is attributed to each domain. Many candidates find the table provides focus for studies during exam preparation. Also included in the blueprint table are the more specific tasks associated with each domain. Pay particular attention to these tasks, as they provide more targeted areas of study within the domains.

1. Network Security Fundamentals 17%

- 1.1 Explain Application Layer inspection for Strata and SASE products
- 1.2 Explain the functionality of slow path and fast path for packet inspection
- 1.3 Explain the use of decryption on Strata and SASE products (e.g., SSL Forward Proxy, SSL Inbound Inspection, SSH Proxy, no decrypt)
- 1.4 Explain the application of network hardening methods for enhanced security on Strata and SASE products (e.g., Content-ID, Zero Trust, User-ID, Device-ID, Zones)

2. NGFW and SASE Solution Functionality 13%

- 2.1 Explain the function of Cloud NGFWs, PA-Series, CN-Series, and VM-Series firewalls (e.g., perimeter and core security, zone security and segmentation, high availability [HA], security and NAT policy implementation, monitoring and logging)
- 2.2 Explain the function of Prisma SD-WAN (e.g., WAN optimization, path and NAT policies, Zone-based firewalls, monitoring and logging)
- 2.3 Explain the function of Prisma Access (e.g., remote user configuration, remote network configuration, public and private application access, security and NAT policy implementation, monitoring and logging)
- 2.4 Explain the functionality of Panorama and Strata Cloud Manager (SCM) for managing Strata and SASE solutions

3. Platform Solutions, Services, and Tools 30%

- 3.1 Explain the security efficacy of Palo Alto Networks NGFW and Prisma SASE products (e.g., security and NAT policy, User-ID, App-ID, decryption, monitoring and logging)
- 3.2 Explain the functionality of Cloud-Delivered Security Services (CDSS) components
 - 3.2.1 Internet of things (IoT) security
 - 3.2.2 Enterprise Data Loss Prevention (DLP)
 - 3.2.3 SaaS Security
 - 3.2.4 PAN-OS SD-WAN
 - 3.2.5 Premium GlobalProtect
 - 3.2.6 Advanced WildFire, Advanced Threat Prevention, Advanced URL Filtering, and Advanced DNS
- 3.3 Explain the alignment of AIOps to Palo Alto Networks best practices (e.g., dashboards, Best Practice Assessment [BPA], administration)

- 3.4 Explain how Next-Generation Trust Security (NGTS) supports identity governance, trust relationships, and adaptive security decisions across the enterprise platform
- 3.5 Identify and describe quantum security risks (e.g., harvest now, decrypt later attacks) and Palo Alto Networks platform capabilities to address them (e.g., post-quantum readiness, hybrid cryptography)
- 3.6 Identify and describe AI-related security risks and mitigation techniques (e.g., AI use, sensitive data exposure, AI application access, AI-enabled threats) and explain how Palo Alto Networks platform capabilities can help discover, monitor, control, and secure them

4. NGFW and SASE Solution Maintenance and Configuration 10%

- 4.1 Explain the configuration and maintenance of Palo Alto Networks hardware firewalls, VM-Series firewalls, CN-Series firewalls, and Cloud NGFWs (e.g., Security policies, profiles, updates, upgrades)
- 4.2 Explain the configuration and maintenance of Prisma Access (e.g., Security policies, profiles, updates, upgrades, monitoring and logging)

5. Infrastructure Management and CDSS 17%

- 5.1 Explain the function of Security policies, profiles, and updates in the configuration and maintenance of CDSS
- 5.2 Explain the function of Security policies, Device-IDs, and monitoring and logging in the configuration and maintenance of IoT security
- 5.3 Explain the function of data encryption, access control, and monitoring and logging in the configuration and maintenance of Enterprise DLP and Enterprise SaaS Security
- 5.4 Explain the function of supported products, new device addition, reporting, and configuration management in SCM and Panorama in network security environments

6. Connectivity and Security 13%

- 6.1 Explain the configuration and maintenance of network security for on-premises, cloud, and hybrid networks (e.g., network segmentation, policies, monitoring and logging, certificates)
- 6.2 Identify and describe the components used to maintain connectivity and security of remote users (e.g., remote access solutions, network segmentation, Security policy tuning, monitoring and logging, certificates)

English as a Second Language (ESL) Accommodation

All exams are delivered worldwide in English. A 30-minute time extension is provided by default to candidates testing in non-English speaking countries.

Learning Resources

Learning Path

The complete Palo Alto Networks recommended learning path can be found [here](#).

Recommended Preparation

Palo Alto Networks certification exam items are developed and approved by exam development experts in conjunction with subject matter experts (SMEs) who represent a broad spectrum of roles relevant to each certification. Each item is referenced to a publicly available technical or scholarly source.

This datasheet provides the full blueprint to which the exam items are written. A solid foundation of the knowledge, skills, and abilities required to pass this certification exam can be achieved by researching keywords from each topic area included in the blueprint—either through the use of an AI-powered browser or directly within Palo Alto Networks documentation—and completing relevant coursework found in the learning path.

Exam Registration

Register for Palo Alto Networks certification exams at Pearson Professional Assessments [here](#).



3000 Tannery Way
Santa Clara, CA 95054

Main: +1.408.753.4000

Sales: +1.866.320.4788

Support: +1.866.898.9087

www.paloaltonetworks.com

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